

## Third Sunday After Pentecost

Dominica Tertia Post Pentecosten

TLM propers: humility, vigilance, and the shepherd's joy

| Proper    | TLM text / reference                                                 | Scriptural axis                                        | Fathers and saints                                              | Connection                                                                               |
|-----------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Introit   | <i>Respice in me, et miserere mei</i> (Ps. 24)                       | Poverty before God                                     | St. Augustine, Enarrationes in Psalmos; St. Francis of Assisi   | The soul begins as solitary and poor, but poverty becomes the place where mercy is seen. |
| Collect   | God as protector; temporal goods passed through toward eternal goods | Pilgrimage and right use                               | St. Gregory of Nyssa on ascent; St. Augustine, City of God XIX  | Temporal goods are not despised but traversed under God's rule.                          |
| Epistle   | 1 Pet. 5:6-11                                                        | Humility under God's hand; vigilance against the devil | St. Leo the Great on humility; St. Anthony and desert vigilance | The Christian resists not by self-trust but by sober humility and faith.                 |
| Gospel    | Luke 15:1-10                                                         | Lost sheep and lost drachma                            | St. Ambrose on Luke; St. Gregory the Great on pastoral care     | The murmuring of the righteous is answered by heaven's joy over repentance.              |
| Offertory | <i>Sperant in te omnes</i> (Ps. 9)                                   | Trust of the poor                                      | St. Basil on care for the poor                                  | The poor are not forgotten; the offering becomes their prayer in the Church.             |
| Communion | <i>Gaudium est Angelis Dei</i> (Luke 15:10)                          | Angelic joy over one sinner                            | St. Bernard on conversion; St. Therese of Lisieux on confidence | Communion is not a prize for the never-lost but the feast of being found.                |

## Four Senses of Scripture

| Thread             | Synthesis                                                                                                                                                         |
|--------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Literal</b>     | Luke 15 recounts Christ receiving sinners and answering murmurers with the lost sheep and lost drachma; 1 Peter exhorts humility, vigilance, and trust.           |
| <b>Allegorical</b> | The shepherd is Christ bearing fallen humanity home on his shoulders, and the woman searching the house images the Church seeking the lost by the light of grace. |
| <b>Moral</b>       | The sinner must let himself be found through humility and repentance, while the devout must renounce murmuring and rejoice at another's return.                   |
| <b>Anagogical</b>  | The Communion antiphon points to heavenly joy: one repentant sinner on earth becomes the occasion of angelic gladness in heaven.                                  |

## Homily Sketch

**Proposition.** The Christian life is not self-rescue. Humility lets itself be found, carried, restored, and made the cause of joy in heaven.

**Opening movement.** The Introit speaks as one poor and alone: *unicus et pauper sum ego*. The Gospel answers that loneliness with a shepherd who notices one missing sheep and a woman who searches for one lost coin.

**Doctrinal center.** The Epistle gives the interior posture of the found sinner: humility under God's mighty hand, sobriety, vigilance, and resistance in faith. Grace does not make vigilance unnecessary; it makes vigilance hopeful.

**Moral turn.** The murmuring Pharisee is the danger inside the devout soul. He can be near religion and far from the joy of God.

## Exegetical Notes

- Luke 15 begins with publicans and sinners drawing near. The first movement belongs to grace: sinners are attracted to Christ.
- The lost sheep is not lectured back; it is carried. This supports a homily on confession, absolution, and pastoral patience.
- The Epistle's devil imagery is not theatrical. Pride isolates; isolation makes the soul easier to devour.

| Witness                | Short text                                      | Homiletic use                                                               |
|------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| St. Gregory the Great  | The shepherd places the sheep on his shoulders. | Preach Christ's Passion as the shoulders on which the sinner is borne home. |
| St. Ambrose            | The sheep is wearied, not despised.             | Use this to distinguish contrition from self-hatred.                        |
| St. Peter              | "Casting all your care upon him." 1 Pet. 5:7    | Let the scriptural phrase become the invitation to confession and trust.    |
| St. Therese of Lisieux | Confidence and love are her way to God.         | Connect childlike confidence with being carried by the Shepherd.            |

| Thread                       | Synthesis                                                                                                                                  |
|------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Humility and mercy</b>    | Peter's command to humble ourselves prepares us to be found. The sheep is carried because it cannot restore itself.                        |
| <b>Vigilance and joy</b>     | The devil hunts by isolation and despair; the Gospel answers with a shepherd who searches and a heaven that rejoices.                      |
| <b>Murmuring and mission</b> | The Pharisee asks why Christ receives sinners; the Church must answer by becoming the place where repentant sinners are actually received. |
| <b>Poverty and praise</b>    | The Introit's poor man becomes the Communion's cause of angelic joy. Poverty under mercy turns into doxology.                              |
| <b>Prayer focus</b>          | Replace anxious self-repair with a concrete act of humble confession and renewed trust in the Shepherd.                                    |

## Preaching Applications

- Speak directly to shame: the Gospel does not minimize sin, but it puts the initiative of mercy first.
- Warn the devout against joyless correctness when another sinner returns.
- Invite confession as the practical enactment of being found and carried.

## Primary References

- Missale Romanum 1962, *Dominica Tertia post Pentecosten*.
- Suggested patristic study: Ambrose on Luke 15; Gregory the Great, Pastoral Rule; Augustine on Psalm 24.

## Full Patristic and Saintly Texts

- St. Augustine, Homily 7 on First John: “Be humble, bear your Lord; be the beast for Him to sit on.”
- St. Augustine, Homily 7 on First John: “Peter, says He, do you love me? Feed my sheep.”